

Meoncross School History Department

YEAR 11 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-2027)

Curriculum Planning & Lesson Companion

Key Stage 4 Curriculum Architecture & Edexcel GCSE Specification

Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1) History Specification (1H10)

Meoncross School delivers a balanced 4-unit curriculum covering thematic development, British depth, period conflict, and modern world history:

Exam Paper & Topic	Assessment Focus	Weighting	Format & Marks	Taught Cohort
Paper 1 (1H10/11): Medicine in Britain (c.1250–present) & Western Front (1914–18)	Thematic Study & Historic Environment	30% of GCSE	1 hr 15 mins 52 marks (incl. 4 SPaG)	Year 11
Paper 2 (1H10/26): Conflict in the Middle East (1945–1995)	Period Study	20% of GCSE	50 mins 32 marks	Year 10
Paper 2 (1H10/26): Early Elizabethan England (1558–1588)	British Depth Study	20% of GCSE	55 mins 32 marks	Year 11
Paper 3 (1H10/31): Weimar and Nazi Germany (1918–1939)	Modern Depth Study	30% of GCSE	1 hr 20 mins 52 marks (incl. 4 SPaG)	Year 10

Assessment Objectives (AOs)

- **AO1 (35%):** Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of key features.
- **AO2 (35%):** Explain and analyse events, causes, consequences, and change.
- **AO3 (15%):** Analyse, evaluate, and use contemporary sources.
- **AO4 (15%):** Analyse and evaluate historical interpretations in context.

Standardized Question Frameworks

- **4-mark Consequence:** PEE structure (immediate & long-term).
- **8-mark Narrative:** 3-phase chronological causal flowchart.
- **8-mark Importance:** Analytical criteria for historical impact.
- **2+2 Features:** Concisely identifying and developing features.
- **8-mark Utility:** Evaluating content and provenance (Author/Audience/Motive).
- **16+4 Judgement Essays:** Evaluative criteria with sustained balance.

Mastery Methodology: GCSE pupils utilize printed Edexcel Mastery Booklets featuring 3-tier models, formula stamps, and walking-talking mock rehearsals, ensuring complete familiarity with mark schemes and timing constraints prior to the final examinations.

Paper 1: Medicine Through Time with the Western Front

Year 11 | How has medicine changed from c1250 to the modern day?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 KT1.1: What did Medieval people believe caused illness?	• Explain how supernatural and religious factors influenced beliefs about the cause of illness. • Analyse the rational, natural theories of disease used in medieval England.	• Exam Practice (12 marks): Explain why there was so little change in ideas about the cause of disease in the years c.1250–c.1500.
Lesson 2 KT1.2: How did Medieval people try to prevent and treat disease?	• Explain the connection between medieval beliefs about disease and their approaches to treatment and prevention. • Evaluate the roles, training, and accessibility of different medical healers in medieval society.	• Exam Practice (12 marks): Explain why there was little change in the care provided by hospitals in the period c.1250–c.1500.

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 3 KT1.3: How did people respond to the Black Death?	- Explain the religious and supernatural responses to the Black Death. - Analyse the rational and governmental methods used to prevent and treat the plague.	Exam Practice (16 marks): 'The main reason why medical care and treatment was ineffective during the medieval period (c1250–c1500) was because medical knowledge was based on Galen's ideas.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks + 4 marks for SPaG)
Lesson 4 KT2.1: Did the Renaissance change beliefs about the causes of illness?	- Explain how Thomas Sydenham's scientific approach to observation changed the diagnosis of disease. - Assess the role of the printing press and the Royal Society in communicating and spreading scientific ideas.	Exam Practice (12 marks): Explain why there were changes in the way ideas about the causes of disease and illness were communicated in the period c1500–c1700. (12 marks)
Lesson 5 KT2.2: Did treatments improve during the Renaissance?	- Analyze the continuities and changes in Renaissance treatments and preventions, including the impact of exploration and alchemy. - Explain how institutional changes, specifically the Dissolution of the Monasteries, altered hospital care in England.	Exam Practice (12 marks): Explain why there was rapid progress in anatomical knowledge in the Renaissance period (c1500–c1700). (12 marks)
Lesson 6 KT2.3: How significant were William Harvey and the Great Plague?	- Explain the significance of William Harvey's discovery and the reasons for its limited short-term impact. - Compare the government and public responses to the 1665 Great Plague with the 1348 Black Death.	Exam Practice (16 marks): 'The most effective method of preventing the spread of the Great Plague (1665) was the use of quarantine.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks + 4 marks for SPaG)
Lesson 7 KT3.1: What breakthrough discoveries changed our understanding of disease causes?	- Explain the difference between Spontaneous Generation and Germ Theory. - Analyze the significance of Robert Koch's scientific methodology in microbiology.	Exam Practice (16 marks): 'Louis Pasteur's publication of the Germ Theory was the biggest turning point in understanding the causes of disease.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.
Lesson 8 KT3.2: How did the Industrial Revolution transform prevention and treatment?	- Explain how hospital care and nursing standards were transformed c1700–c1900 under the influence of Florence Nightingale. - Analyse how the breakthroughs of anaesthetics and antiseptics solved the critical surgical problems of pain and infection. - Evaluate the role of government intervention in disease prevention through the 1875 Public Health Act.	Exam Practice (16 marks): 'The discovery of Carbolic Acid was the most significant turning point in surgery in the years c1700–c1900.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks + 4 marks for SPaG)
Lesson 9 KT3.3: How significant were Edward Jenner and John Snow?	- Explain the significance and limitations of Edward Jenner's development of the smallpox vaccine. - Analyze how John Snow investigated the 1854 cholera epidemic and assess the significance of his findings.	Exam Practice (12 marks): Explain why there was rapid progress in public health in the second half of the nineteenth century (c1850–c1900). (12 marks)
Lesson 10 KT4.1: How have modern discoveries changed our understanding of illness?	- Explain how the discovery of DNA and the Human Genome Project transformed the understanding of genetic and hereditary illnesses. - Analyze the influence of lifestyle choices on modern health and the impact of technology on medical diagnosis.	Exam Practice (16 marks): 'The discovery of DNA was the most significant breakthrough in understanding the causes of illness in the period c.1900–present.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.
Lesson 11 KT4.2: How have prevention and treatment advanced in the modern era?	- Explain how scientific and technological developments led to the creation of magic bullets and antibiotics. - Analyze the impact of the National Health Service (NHS) on the provision of and access to medical care.	Exam Practice (12 marks): Explain why there was rapid progress in disease prevention in the period c1900–present. (12 marks)

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 12 KT4.3: How was Penicillin discovered and mass-produced?	- Contrast the roles of Alexander Fleming with those of Howard Florey and Ernst Chain in the penicillin breakthrough. - Analyze how the factors of government intervention, science and technology, and war collaborated to enable the mass production of penicillin.	Exam Practice (16 marks): 'Alexander Fleming was the most important individual in the development of penicillin.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks + 4 marks for SPaG)
Lesson 13 KT4.4: How has the government tackled the modern epidemic of Lung Cancer?	- Explain how modern science and technology have transformed the diagnosis and treatment of lung cancer since c1900. - Analyze the effectiveness and changing focus of government legislation to prevent smoking-related lung cancer.	Exam Practice (12 marks): Explain why the government took action to improve public health in the period c1900-present. (12 marks)
Lesson 14 KT5.1: What was the historical and medical context of the Western Front?	Explain the state of surgical asepsis, radiology, and transfusion science on the eve of World War I.	- Exam Practice (2 marks): Describe one feature of aseptic surgery in the early 20th century. (2 marks) - Exam Practice (2 marks): Describe one feature of early x-ray machines. (2 marks) - Exam Practice (8 marks): How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the state of medical technology available to British doctors on the eve of the First World War? Explain your answer, using Sources A and B and your knowledge of the historical context. - Exam Practice (4 marks): How could you follow up Source A to find out more about the problem of storing blood before the First World War?
Lesson 15 KT5.2: How did the trench environment create new medical challenges?	- Explain the causes, symptoms, and preventive strategies developed to combat trench foot and trench fever. - Analyze the impact of weaponry on injuries, specifically focusing on shrapnel, head injuries, and gas gangrene from soil.	- Exam Practice (2 marks): Describe one feature of the support trench system on the Western Front. (2 marks) - Exam Practice (2 marks): Describe one feature of the problems involved in transporting wounded soldiers away from the battleground. (2 marks) - Exam Practice (8 marks): How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the difficulties faced by soldiers in the trench system of the Western Front? Explain your answer, using Sources A and B and your knowledge of the historical context. - Exam Practice (4 marks): How could you follow up Source A to find out more about the work of the stretcher bearers on the Western Front? - Exam Practice (4 marks): How could you follow up Source A to find out more about the problem of trench foot?
Lesson 16 KT5.3: What new illnesses and wounds did soldiers face?	- Explain the connection between artillery weaponry, shrapnel, and the introduction of the steel Brodie helmet in 1915. - Analyse how the muddy, manured environment of Flanders led to severe wound infections like gas gangrene and tetanus.	- Exam Practice (2 marks): Describe one feature of poison gas attacks on the Western Front. (2 marks) - Exam Practice (2 marks): Describe one feature of the fighting on the Western Front that led to a high number of injuries. (2 marks) - Exam Practice (8 marks): How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the problem of ill health arising from the trench environment? Explain your answer, using Sources A and B and your knowledge of the historical context. - Exam Practice (4 marks): How could you follow up Source A to find out more about the treatment and prevention of the effects of gas attacks?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 17 KT5.4: How did the RAMC and FANY operate the chain of evacuation?	- Explain the four main stages of the Western Front chain of evacuation and the mode of transport between them. - Evaluate the roles, significance, and contributions of the RAMC and FANY on the Western Front.	- Exam Practice (2 marks): Describe one feature of the underground hospital at Arras. (2 marks) - Exam Practice (2 marks): Describe one feature of the work of the FANY on the Western Front. (2 marks) - Exam Practice (8 marks): How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the work of medical staff in the Casualty Clearing Stations (CCS) on the Western Front? Explain your answer, using Sources A and B and your knowledge of the historical context. - Exam Practice (4 marks): How could you follow up Source A to find out more about the work of medical staff in the Casualty Clearing Stations?
Lesson 18 KT5.5: What incredible medical advances were forged on the Western Front?	- Explain how the Thomas splint and mobile X-ray units solved critical evacuation and surgical challenges. - Analyze the development of blood transfusion and the significance of the first blood bank at the Battle of Cambrai.	- Exam Practice (2 marks): Describe one feature of the Thomas Splint. (2 marks) - Exam Practice (2 marks): Describe one feature of the medical advances in blood transfusions on the Western Front. (2 marks) - Exam Practice (8 marks): How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the effectiveness of new medical developments used to treat wounded soldiers on the Western Front? Explain your answer, using Sources A and B and your knowledge of the historical context. - Exam Practice (4 marks): How could you follow up Source A to find out more about new techniques being used on the Western Front to deal with injuries?

Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88

Year 11 | From religious division to the Armada: How did Elizabeth secure her throne?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 KT1.1: The situation on Elizabeth's accession, 1558	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	- Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of Elizabethan society in 1558. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of Elizabethan government in 1558. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the financial weaknesses Elizabeth faced upon her accession in 1558. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the French threat to England in 1558. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Explain why Elizabeth's legitimacy was questioned when she became queen in 1558. Stimulus: Her parents' marriage / Mary, Queen of Scots - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Explain why Elizabeth was reluctant to marry when she became queen. Stimulus: Royal power / Foreign suitors - Exam Practice (undefined marks): 'The problem of Elizabeth's legitimacy was the main problem she faced when she became queen in 1558.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Royal finances / The French threat - Exam Practice (undefined marks): 'Financial weakness was Elizabeth's main problem when she became queen in 1558.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: The Crown's debt / Elizabeth's legitimacy

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 2 KT1.2: The 'settlement' of religion, 1559	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	- Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the Act of Supremacy (1559). - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the Act of Uniformity (1559). - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the role of the Church of England in society. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the Royal Injunctions of 1559. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Explain why Elizabeth introduced a Religious Settlement in 1559. Stimulus: Religious divisions in England / The 'Middle Way' - Exam Practice (undefined marks): 'Elizabeth's religious settlement was successful.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: The 'middle way' / Catholic rebels in England
Lesson 3 KT1.3: Challenge to the religious settlement	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	- Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the Puritan challenge to the Religious Settlement. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the Catholic challenge to the Religious Settlement. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of recusancy in early Elizabethan England. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Explain why the Puritans challenged Elizabeth's religious settlement. Stimulus: Vestments / Crucifixes - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Explain why English Catholics challenged Elizabeth's religious settlement. Stimulus: Papal authority / Catholic nobility - Exam Practice (undefined marks): 'The most significant challenge to Elizabeth I's religious settlement, in the years 1558–68, came from English Catholics.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Recusancy fines / The Puritan campaign against crucifixes
Lesson 4 KT1.4: The problem of Mary, Queen of Scots	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	- Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of Mary, Queen of Scots' claim to the English throne. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the relations between Elizabeth and Mary, Queen of Scots, in the years 1568–69. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Explain why Mary, Queen of Scots' arrival in England in 1568 created problems for Elizabeth. Stimulus: Legitimacy / Catholic alternative - Exam Practice (undefined marks): 'Mary Queen of Scots was the greatest threat to Elizabeth's rule.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Catholic plots / Foreign intervention - Exam Practice (undefined marks): 'The main cause of tension between Elizabeth and Mary, Queen of Scots, was Mary's claim to the English throne.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Elizabeth's legitimacy / Plots

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 5 KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home	- Describe what happened during the Revolt of the Northern Earls. - List the main Catholic plots against Elizabeth. - Explain how Walsingham used spies to catch plotters.	- Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the Revolt of the Northern Earls, 1569–70. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the Ridolfi plot. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the Throckmorton plot. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the Babington plot. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of Sir Francis Walsingham's use of spies. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Explain why the Revolt of the Northern Earls took place in 1569. Stimulus: Loss of political power / Religion - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Explain why Mary, Queen of Scots, was executed in 1587. [Aligned to Spec Topic] Stimulus: The Babington Plot / Sir Francis Walsingham - Exam Practice (undefined marks): 'The main reason for the failure of Catholic plots against Elizabeth was the work of Sir Francis Walsingham.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Spies / Lack of foreign support - Exam Practice (undefined marks): 'The Revolt of the Northern Earls was the most significant challenge to Elizabeth's rule in the years 1569–86.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Earl of Northumberland / Babington's execution (1586)
Lesson 6 KT2.2: Relations with Spain	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	- Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of English privateering in the New World. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the religious rivalry between England and Spain. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of Sir Francis Drake's activities in the Americas. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Explain why relations between England and Spain became worse in the years 1569–88. Stimulus: Catholic rebels in England / English trade in the Netherlands - Exam Practice (undefined marks): 'Commercial rivalry was the main cause of the growing tension between England and Spain in the years 1570–88.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Privateering / Religious differences
Lesson 7 KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88	- List the reasons why England and Spain became enemies. - Describe what Robert Dudley did in the Netherlands. - Explain how Francis Drake's raid on Cadiz helped England.	- Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of English involvement in the Netherlands, 1585–88. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of Drake's raid on Cadiz in 1587. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of Robert Dudley's actions in the Netherlands. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Explain why Elizabeth signed the Treaty of Nonsuch in 1585. Stimulus: The Netherlands / Dutch Protestant rebels - Exam Practice (undefined marks): 'Drake's raid on Cadiz was the most important reason for the delay of the Spanish Armada.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Wooden barrel staves / Financial impact on Spain

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 8 KT2.4: The Armada	- List the reasons why Philip II launched the Armada. - Describe the Spanish plan and why it went wrong. - Explain how the English defeated the Armada. - Describe what happened after the Armada was defeated.	- Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the Spanish invasion plans for the Armada. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of English tactics used to defeat the Spanish Armada. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the Battle of Gravelines. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Explain why the Spanish Armada was defeated in 1588. Stimulus: Fireships / English ship design - Exam Practice (undefined marks): 'The English defeated the Spanish Armada because of superior ship design and naval tactics.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Long-range culverins / The 'Protestant Wind'
Lesson 9 KT3.1: Education and leisure	- Describe the different types of schools in Elizabethan England. - List some sports played by the nobility and the lower classes. - Explain why the theatre was popular and why some people hated it.	- Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of education in Elizabethan Grammar Schools. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of Elizabethan Petty Schools. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the Elizabethan theatre. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of Elizabethan sport and pastimes. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Explain why there was an increase in the number of schools in early Elizabethan England. Stimulus: Humanism / Growth of trade and business - Exam Practice (undefined marks): 'The theatre was the most popular form of entertainment for all classes.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: The groundlings / Royal patronage - Exam Practice (undefined marks): 'There was little change in education in Early Elizabethan England.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Petty schools / Education for girls
Lesson 10 KT3.2: The Problem of Poverty	- List the main reasons why poverty increased. - Describe the difference between the 'deserving' and 'undeserving' poor. - Explain why people were so afraid of vagabonds. - Describe the difference between the 1572 and 1576 Poor Laws.	- Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the 1572 Vagabonds Act. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the 1576 Poor Relief Act. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the Houses of Correction. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Explain why there was an increase in poverty in the years 1558–88. Stimulus: Unemployment / Bad harvests - Exam Practice (undefined marks): 'The main reason for the increase in poverty in the years 1558–88 was the increasing population of England.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Demand for food / Enclosure and sheep farming

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 11 KT3.3: Exploration and voyages of discovery	- List the reasons why Elizabethan sailors started exploring the world. - Describe Francis Drake's circumnavigation and why it angered Spain. - Explain why Walter Raleigh wanted to start a colony in America. - Describe the reasons why the Virginia colony completely failed.	- Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of Francis Drake's circumnavigation of the globe. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the impact of new technology on Elizabethan exploration. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Explain why exploration by the English increased in the years 1558–88. Stimulus: Navigational instruments / Drive to expand trade - Exam Practice (undefined marks): 'New technology was the main reason why exploration by the English increased in the years 1558–88.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Quadrant and astrolabe / Privateering profits - Exam Practice (undefined marks): 'Drake's most significant achievement, in the years 1558–88, was his circumnavigation of the globe.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: The Golden Hind / Raid on Cadiz
Lesson 12 KT3.4: Raleigh and Virginia	- Explain what Walter Raleigh did to organise the Virginia expeditions. - List the reasons why England wanted a colony in America. - Describe the problems faced by the 1585 and 1587 colonies.	- Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of the failure of the first Virginia colony. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Describe one feature of Sir Walter Raleigh's role in the attempted colonisation of Virginia. - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Explain why the first colony in Virginia failed. Stimulus: Native Americans / Damage to The Tiger - Exam Practice (undefined marks): Explain why there was an attempt to colonise Virginia in 1585. Stimulus: Sir Walter Raleigh / New trade routes - Exam Practice (undefined marks): 'Poor planning was the main reason why the first colony in Virginia failed.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: The choice of colonists / Lack of food supplies